CLIENT PORTAL · LMS · FINANCE TRACKER · ON YOUR WORDPRESS + WOOCOMMERCE

Plugins for the standard parts, one small tested plugin for the rest

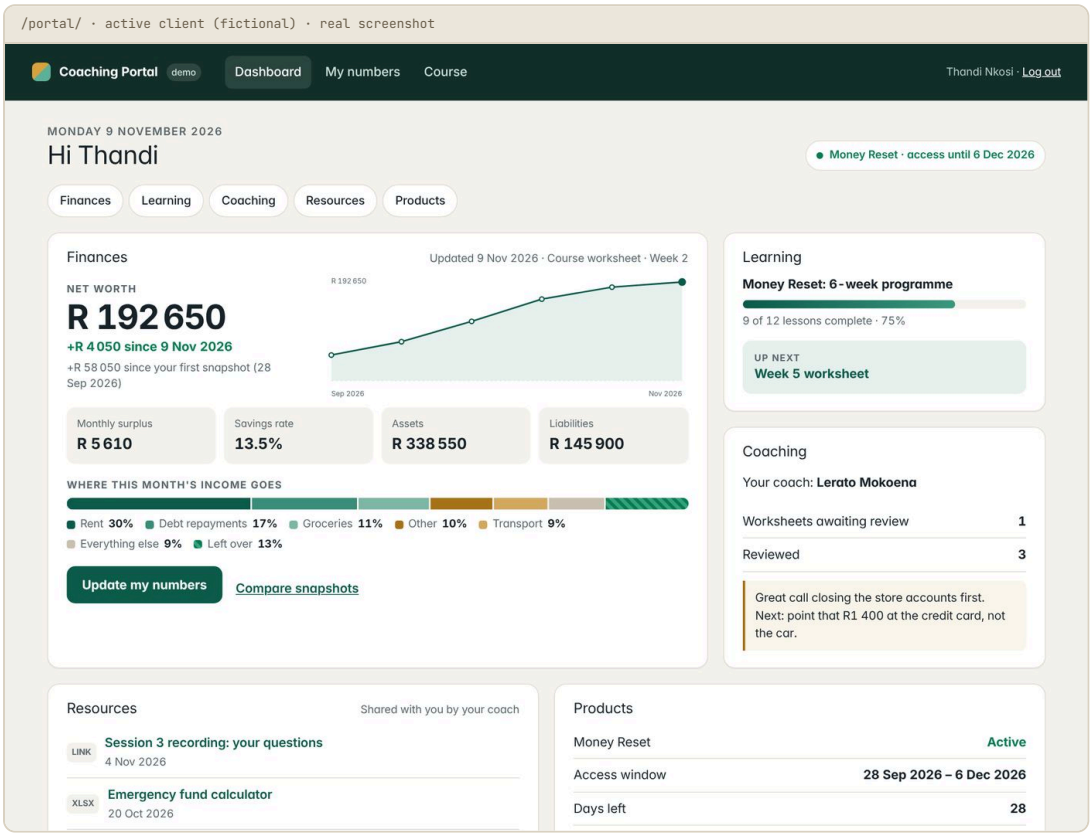
Before quoting, I installed WordPress 7.1.4, built the custom layer your brief needs (finance snapshots, programme access windows, per-client resources, the dashboard), and tested it with fictional clients. The screenshots are the running site, and the numbers were measured on it.

PayPal can't charge in rand.

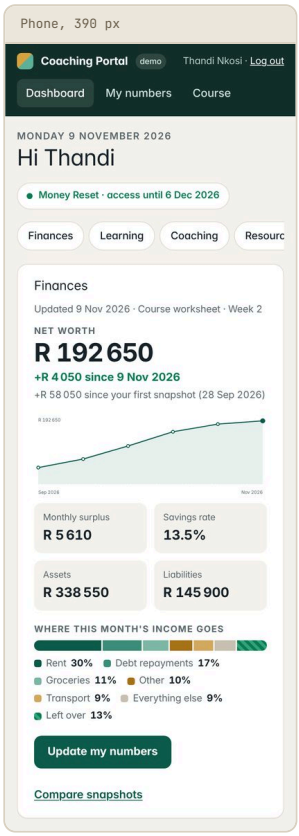
PayPal doesn't support ZAR, and store owners report that WooCommerce's PayPal gateway won't switch on for a rand-priced store. Monthly renewals through PayPal alone would bill South African clients in a foreign currency. Payfast, the official WooCommerce gateway, charges in rand, works with WooCommerce Subscriptions (with ad hoc payments enabled), and accepts international Visa and Mastercard. PayPal stays only if some clients need it.

PLUGIN TESTS	LIVE HTTP CHECKS	SIMULATOR PARITY	DASHBOARD API
29/29	14/14	2,021/2,021	5.2 ms
132 assertions, WordPress 7.1.4	real logins, cookies, nonces	browser port vs PHP engine	p50, client with 520 snapshots

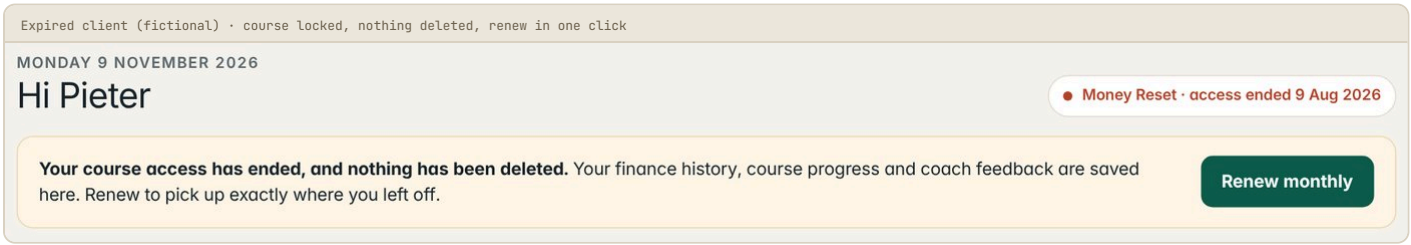
/portal/ · active client (fictional) · real screenshot



Phone, 390 px



Expired client (fictional) · course locked, nothing deleted, renew in one click



The stack

Client · Coach · Admin
one login, three views; clients never see wp-admin

WordPress + Elementor (your current site)

WooCommerce
checkout, invoices

Payfast · PayPal
rand + international

Woo Subscriptions
optional monthly

LearnDash
courses, video, quizzes, assignment review

ww-portal (custom, ≈1,700 lines)
snapshots · access windows · resources · dashboard · audit

Your 22 requirements

8 plugin or setting · 13 custom, drafted and tested · 1 training

- **Plugin:** accounts, six-week courses with video and worksheets, progress, assignment uploads with coach review, the course builder, checkout, LearnDash data-deletion off, expired clients still able to log in and buy.
- **Custom:** the dashboard and its sections, the finance worksheet, net worth and surplus, dated snapshots and compare, course data shown outside the course, history preserved, per-client resources, access on purchase, 10 weeks from the agreed start, subscription restore, finance-data protection.

HOW THE RISKY PARTS ARE HANDLED

Access: 10 weeks from the agreed start, renew monthly, lose nothing

LearnDash expiry counts from enrolment

Your rule starts at the agreed programme date. **Fix:** the portal stores access windows from that date, and LearnDash expiry stays off.

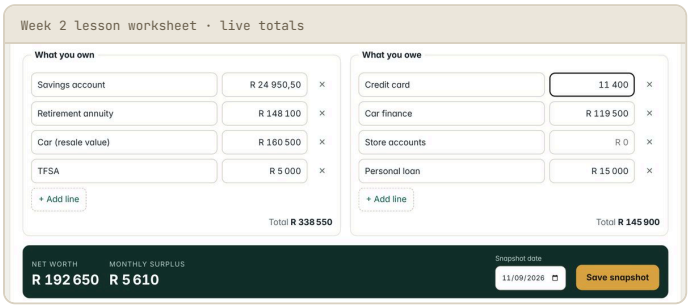
Expiry can delete course data

LearnDash's optional switch deletes course and quiz data, and it can't be recovered. **Fix:** expiry only removes access. Tests show progress, worksheets, snapshots and the login unchanged.

Cohort end dates beat extensions

Extend Access can't pass a group end date. **Fix:** renewals add a window from where access ends (no gap, no double days) and reopen the course on the same request.

Finance data: typed once, kept forever



- **One store** for the lesson worksheet and the dashboard. Measured end to end: a lesson save became the dashboard's latest figure, up exactly R 4 050.50.
- **Append-only** dated snapshots with a hash chain. A row edited or deleted in the database is flagged at that row.
- **Encrypted** (XChaCha20-Poly1305) with the key in wp-config, not the database, and bound to owner and date. A copied row won't decrypt.
- **Exact money** in integer cents. Accepts "R 12 500,50", "12,500.50", "(2 500)" and more.

Privacy and isolation, checked live

CHECK (REAL BROWSER SESSIONS)	RESULT
Logged-out API call	`401`
`/me/snapshots?user_id=` another client	`own rows only`
Client calling the coach route	`403`
Coach reading another coach's client	`403 + logged`
Direct URL to a private resource file	`403`
Another client's download link	`403`
Expired client logs in, sees history	`yes`
Clients sent away from wp-admin	`yes`
POPIA export / erase via WordPress tools	`one client only, audited`

Plus 29 plugin tests. Speed: snapshot save ~3 ms, nightly sweep of 300 clients ~0.6 s (SQLite sandbox).

Stages and handover

STAGE 1 · PROTOTYPE ON STAGING

- LearnDash with a 6-week course shell
- Dashboard, Week 1 worksheet, snapshots, compare
- Access windows and the Client access screen
- Payfast sandbox checkout granting access

STAGE 2 · COMPLETE SYSTEM, LIVE

- Monthly continue or restore, with grace days
- Coach role, worksheet review, audited view
- Resource library, protected files
- Encryption key, POPIA tools, reminder emails, go-live

HANDOVER

- Two recorded trainings: admin and coach
- Admin guide using your own screens
- Code, tests, key and backup notes
- Post-launch support window

Measured

- 29/29 plugin tests, 14/14 live HTTP checks, 2,021/2,021 simulator parity, 25/25 parser parity
- Lesson → dashboard end to end, plus every screenshot
- One real bug caught: "−R 400" couldn't be re-parsed. Fixed and tested.

Not measured yet (runs first on staging)

- LearnDash adapter (licensed, written to its documented API)
- WooCommerce, Subscriptions and Payfast/PayPal hooks, in sandbox
- Your MySQL host and Elementor wrapper; load under many users

Defaults I've chosen (each one can change)

- **Rand store, Payfast first.** PayPal only if some clients need it.
- **The finance tracker keeps working after access ends.** It's the client's data and a reason to come back. Only the course locks.
- **3 grace days** on renewals, so a late debit order doesn't lock anyone out mid-lesson.
- **Coaches see only their assigned clients.** Every view of someone's finances is logged.

Simpler or cheaper, if you prefer

- **Renewal passes instead of subscriptions:** a one-off "continue a month" product. No Subscriptions licence and no recurring setup; clients renew by hand after a reminder.
- **Tutor LMS Pro on a lifetime licence instead of LearnDash:** the portal talks to the LMS through one adapter, so this swaps one file.
- **Payfast only:** one gateway means one set of tests and one reconciliation.

What I need from you to start

Staging access on your host (or permission to create it); admin access to WordPress; your Payfast merchant sandbox details, or I'll walk you through opening the account; one sample week of course material (video links and worksheet) to build the course shell around.